

Battle cries

Medieval castle building or John Woo style action, these games have it all!

WOW! That's what I call AXTION

Now that's what I call *paisa vasool!*

Often you find budget packs with 10-1000 games, crappy console conversions, old classics, or forgotten 'has-beens' that need to be sent to the gas chamber. Fortunately, this isn't one of those packs. Milestone, in association with AXN, brings you *WOW! That's what I call AXTION* a four game pack with *Max Payne*, *Rogue Spear*, *Deus Ex* and *Tomb Raider: The Last Revelation*. A four-in-one game pack for Rs 999.

Having seen a lot of budget packs, this one does stand out for the quality of games. *Max Payne* was just released last year, and it already has a couple of excellent mods that you can use to extend the life of the game. Not much needs to be said about *Max Payne*; it's, quite honestly, one of the best releases from last year.

Tomb Raider: The Last Revelation is a supposed last gasp from the over played Lara Croft series. The Lara Croft franchise is getting old, but this game is perfect for newcomers to the action genre.

Deus Ex is an excellent first person RPG hybrid that will keep you compelled beyond your wits. If you want a break from



The AXTION pack features this critically acclaimed cypherpunk First Person Shooter/RPG hybrid

all out deathmatching, then try the strategy filled *Rogue Spear*, and you won't be disappointed. The game is a much improved version of the original *Rainbow 6* and brings in more and better counter terrorism aspects. It's a must for every arm-chair counter-terrorism operative.

This is a pack meant for action gamers inclined towards playing single player

games. All the games on this pack have a heavy single player element, with the exception of *Rogue Spear* and *Deus Ex*, which have token multiplayer modes.

The packaging is as flimsy as ever, with paper covers and game manuals on the CD. It would have been refreshing to see the collection in a jewel case. It looks like they dumped the surplus inventory into one pack and redistributed it under a different name.

However, these are a good line up of games, premium titles that will stay in the consciousness of gamers for years to come. So here's a gamepack that isn't too outdated, has a good quality of titles, comes at a bargain, and looks like value for money in every way you look at it.

Anyone with a graphics card should definitely consider this.

Genre: Compilation

Developer: Various

Distributor: Milestone Interactive

Phone: 91-022-8381614

Web site: www.milestoneinteractive.com

Price: Rs 999

Rating: ★★★★★

Stronghold He who rules by the sword...

Unlike most Real Time Strategy games, *Stronghold* has a mind and story of its own. This castle simulator from Firefly Studios breaks away from the much beaten path of strategy games by allowing you to play economic campaigns as well.

At first glance *Stronghold* seems like an *Age of Empires* (AOE) look-alike, thanks to its medieval scenarios and castle building gameplay, but that's where the similarity ends.

You play as a feudal lord and can either choose to get into the thick of the action or play it safe and settle for an economic campaign, where you build your castle and manage your town while attempting to complete your objectives.

The game has some realistic landscape animations, such as wind blown trees, and cool sound effects, be it a hunter skinning his kill or a pack of wolves on the prowl. The graphics are a

notch over traditional top down perspective games, with the ability to change your angle of view while exploring the landscape. You can also level any huge mountains or thick forests to look for enemy soldiers lurking behind them!

As a war strategy game, most of *Stronghold's* gameplay arises from managing your town. The population of your town depends on your popularity, which in turn is affected by your policy on taxes